

- **Find out what your bank charges you to use another bank's ATM.** Your bank probably won't charge you for using its ATMs, but will charge you as much as \$3 for using machines that are affiliated with other banks. Your bank won't warn you about this fee—you'll just see it on your next statement. So stick with your own bank's ATM whenever you can.
- **Find out what other banks charge too.** It's the nasty one-two punch of ATM fees: In addition to the fees your own bank may charge you for using another bank's ATM, you will almost certainly also have to pay so-called **surcharges** of as much as \$3 to that other bank. These surcharges can be especially high in places where people need to get money fast, like malls and casinos. I know of one ATM in Las Vegas that charges \$20 per withdrawal! Remember which ATMs carry high surcharges and avoid them when you can, or be sure to withdraw as much as you'll need for the week when you're at your own ATM.

THE \$33.50 PACK OF GUM

When Adam moved to New York City, he signed up for a checking account at a bank near his office and got a debit card linked to the account. The officer who helped him never mentioned that by signing up for the new account, he was automatically enrolled in a courtesy overdraft protection plan. Adam assumed that if he didn't have enough money in his account, he wouldn't be able to use the card to buy things. The Thursday after getting his first paycheck (his company didn't have direct deposit) Adam deposited it into his brand-new account and allowed two days for it to clear. That weekend, Adam figured the funds were already in his account and began to use the card for small purchases. On Saturday, he bought the following things:

Gum	@Pharmacy	\$1.50
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